

SECTION:

Sustainability

SUBJECT:

Office Ergonomics

Introduction

At Acumetis, we believe a healthy workplace starts with a comfortable and supportive work environment. Creating an ergonomic workspace helps reduce strain, improve comfort, and support your overall well-being, whether you're working in the office or at home. Small adjustments to your workstation can make a big difference in preventing discomfort and supporting long-term health. In this course, you'll learn simple ergonomic best practices to help you work safely, comfortably, and effectively every day.

I. Purpose

To provide Acumetis employees with practical ergonomic guidance that supports a safe, comfortable, and productive work environment.

II. Scope

This SOP applies to all Acumetis employees and contractors, whether working remotely, in the office, or in a hybrid environment.

III. Responsibilities

Employees are responsible for following the best ergonomic practices in this SOP and using the guidance provided to help reduce the risk of strain and injury.

IV. Procedure

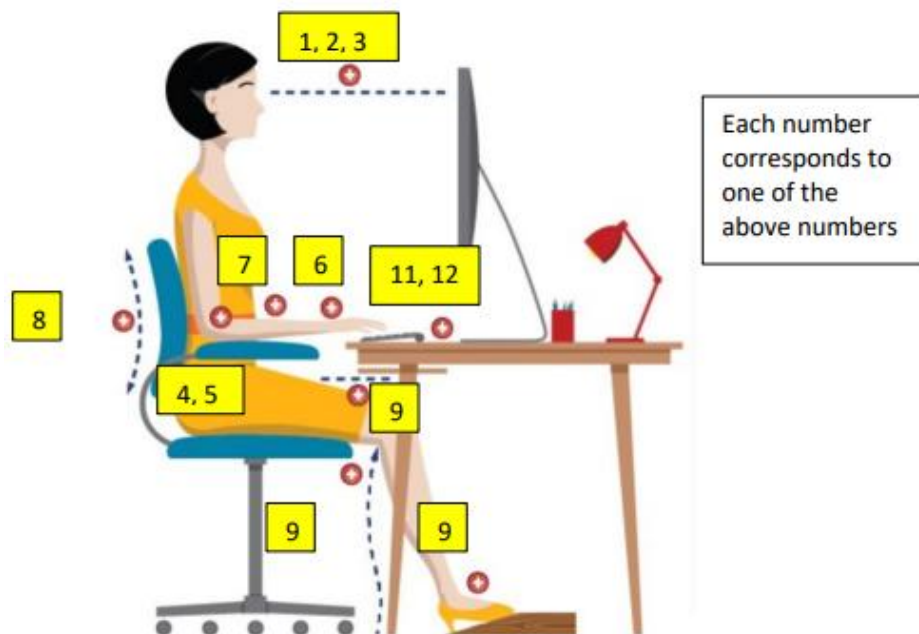
Computer Workstations

Position the monitor so the top of the screen is at or slightly below eye level. Alternatively, adjust the chair height to align your eye level with the top of the monitor. If necessary, use adjustable monitors or monitor arms for proper positioning. If adjustments aren't possible, elevate the monitor using stable items like books. For employees wearing bifocals, it may be helpful to lower the monitor or tilt it slightly to accommodate viewing through the lower portion of the lenses.

1. Position the monitor directly in front of you. If using dual monitors, place the primary monitor directly in front, with the secondary monitor angled to the left or right. Ensure both monitors are at the same height and positioned at an arm's length away.
2. Place monitors at a 90-degree angle to windows, avoiding direct exposure to light. Ensure there is no glare from external light sources.
3. Align the keyboard directly in front of you for optimal comfort.
4. Adjust the height of the keyboard and mouse to match elbow height or adjust the chair accordingly. Alternatively, use an adjustable keyboard and mouse tray. Position the mouse

beside the keyboard and consider using an ergonomic mouse. Maintain a 90-degree angle between your upper and lower arms while typing.

5. Keep wrists straight and aligned with your forearms. Adjust your work surface, keyboard tray, or seat to maintain this posture.
6. Ensure your forearms are supported and your shoulders remain relaxed. Adjust armrest height and width to allow free movement while providing support during rest periods. Keep elbows close to the torso and avoid hunching your shoulders.
7. Make sure your chair provides proper lumbar support. Position the lumbar support at waist level to fit the natural curve of your lower back.
8. Ensure your feet are flat on the floor or on a footrest, with thighs parallel to the ground. The back of your knees should not touch the front edge of the seat. Adjust the chair depth so there is space for 2-3 fingers behind your knees.
9. Ensure adequate lighting is available in your workspace.
10. Keep frequently used items, such as calculators, within easy reach.
11. If needed, provide document holders to position documents directly in front of you, between the keyboard and monitor, for easy reference.
12. Take regular breaks and stretch every 30 minutes to alleviate tension in your arms and hands and to promote overall comfort.



Hazards to watch out for:

- Leaning forward in your chair.
- Placing pressure on the front part of your thigh.
- Resting your wrist too hard on a sharp or hard surface while typing.
- Extending your arm in front of you or to the side while typing or mousing.
- Bending head forward while reading or viewing a computer screen.

Conclusion

Maintain good posture and neutral body positions to reduce fatigue and enhance both health and safety. If you experience any discomfort or have questions, please reach out to your supervisor.

References

<https://ehs.utoronto.ca/office-ergonomics-infographic/>

<https://www.sfmic.com/resource-catalog/resource/210/>